Higher engagement, lower rank? *Here's why.*

Short answer: **engagement rate is one of four things we score, not the whole score.** Heat runs from 0 to 100 and compares each account with similar accounts of a similar size, on all four parts. Same maths for everyone. No opinions, no hand-picking.

The four parts

Engagement — 35%

Do people react? Likes and comments, divided by followers. Judged against accounts the same size, because big accounts always get a lower rate.

Reach — 25%

Do Reels get seen beyond the people who already follow? Average Reel views ÷ followers, judged for size.

Community — 25%

Do people talk, and does the account keep showing up? Comments per like, plus how steadily it posts.

Interaction quality — 15%

Is the attention deep or shallow? Comment depth and Reel viewers who stick around, judged for size.

How each part is scored

1.0 means "the middle of the group".

We divide the account's number by the group's median. 2.0 is double the middle. 0.5 is half.

Nothing counts for more than 2.0.

One viral post can't carry a whole score. Once you're at double the middle on a part, extra doesn't add points.

Then we weight and scale.

Heat = (Engagement × 0.35 + Reach × 0.25 + Community × 0.25 + Quality × 0.15) × 50. Middle of the pack = 50.

60+	40–59	Under 40
Ahead	In the pack	Behind

Scores compare within a group.

A 70 in Surf brands and a 70 in Snow athletes both mean "ahead of the middle of their own group". Not the same audience size.

So why can a lower engagement rate rank higher?

1. **Engagement is 35%, not 100%.** The other 65% is Reels reach, comments and posting rhythm. An account can win on those.
2. **The 2.0 cap.** If you're already at double the group's middle on engagement, going to triple adds nothing. Anyone who also hits 2.0 is level on that part.
3. **Your rate is judged against your size.** 1.3% is great for 100K followers and ordinary for 5K. We compare like with like, so the raw % on its own can't be ranked.

An example (made-up numbers)

Account A has the better engagement rate. Account B ranks higher.

Part (× group middle)	Account A	Account B	Weight
Engagement	3.0× → counts as 2.0	1.5×	35%
Reach	0.8×	1.4×	25%
Community	1.0×	1.3×	25%
Interaction quality	1.0×	1.1×	15%
Heat	**65**	**68**	

A wins on engagement, and the cap stops that lead growing. B is steadier everywhere else, so B scores higher.

Worth knowing

Public likes, comments and Reel views from the last 90 days. It measures how an audience responds, not sales or brand value. Accounts with under 5K followers, fewer than 5 own posts, or hidden likes show as "Not ranked", with the reason. Under about 12 posts the score is nudged towards 50 and tagged "Early read".